Shaun O'Connell

Aspiring field guide, nature photographer, and seasoned web developer

While I have almost 27 years of experience as a Web Developer, I'm gradually shifting my career towards more conservation-centric roles.

Working experience

Today

NQF2 Field Guide student at EcoTraining (Pty) Ltd.
August, 2026 to present day

I'm currently training for the Professional Field Guide (NQF2 - FGASA) qualification through EcoTraining, this will also include:

- Advanced Rifle Handling (FGASA)
- Trails Guide (FGASA)
- Wilderness First Aid (Level 2)
- Advanced Birding

2026

Freelance Front-end Web Developer at various South African organisations
August, 2024 to present day

In August 2024, I returned to South Africa. During this time I worked primarily as a web developer, but I also used my spare time to improve my photography and birding skills.
Some of the projects I worked on:

- Birds of Zevenwacht
- SASTI @ CREST, Stellenbosch University

2021

Freelance Front-end Web Developer at various New Zealand organisations
February, 2021 to July, 2024

Upon returning to New Zealand after COVID, I primarily worked as a freelance web developer.
Some of my clients and employers included:

- Te Whatu Ora, Health NZ
- Ackama
- Adminis
- Lil Regie

2020

Volunteer Web Development Teacher at Onja Madagascar
December, 2019 to October, 2020

During 2020, I worked in Madagascar, as a volunteer teacher for 20 aspiring web development students.
Feel free to read more about this adventure on my blog.

2019

Senior Front-end Developer & Interaction Designer at various New Zealand organisations
October, 2014 to December, 2019

In October 2014, I moved to New Zealand for work.
I worked with several organisations over the 5 years:

- Abletech and AddressFinder
- Homes.co.nz
- Tangram at Trade Me
- Flick Electric co.

2014

Front-end Developer & Interaction Designer at various South African organisations
January, 1999 to August, 2014

I then worked in South Africa for several organisations over 15 years, including: Dimension Data, Consology, CareerJunction.
Kalahari.com, Yola, 22seven

1998

Junior Web Developer

My career started in 1998 with *Sams Teach Yourself HTML4*. I started making websites shortly thereafter.

Then in the August of that year, I studied programming (COBOL) at Van Zyl & Pritchard

Skills

General skills

- Nature photography
- Bird surveying and identification
- Birding tours / guiding

Tech-specific skills

- Web development, design systems development
- Storyboarding, prototyping, and interaction design
- Usability research
- General IT, networking, etc.

Interests

Birding & Wildlife	Birding has been an interest for me over the last 40 years, but it wasn't until 2024 that I started prioritising my learning here. Take a look at my eBird and iNaturalist profiles. I'm also a contributor to SABAP2.
Volunteering	I work in my spare time as a volunteer. Offering mentorship to junior web developers, as well as aiding conservation efforts.
Photography	I'm particularly interested in Bird, wildlife, landscape, macro, and astro photography.

Get in touch

- Visit my site: tactile.co.za
- Email me: shaun@tactile.co.za
- LinkedIn: ndorfin
- GitHub: ndorfin

The latest version of this CV is available online at ndorfin.github.io/cv